

ZIHENG YU

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Department of Economics ◇ The University of Texas at Austin

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EDUCATION

Aug 2021 - Present	Ph.D. in Economics, The University of Texas at Austin • Field courses: Theory, Public Finance
Aug 2019 - Dec 2020	M.A. Economics, Duke University
Sep 2015 - Jun 2019	Bachelor in Economics, Wuhan University

RESEARCH

Fields and Interests

Game Theory, Theoretical Industrial Organization, Microeconomic Theory, Market Structure, Two-Sided Platform, Information Design

Working Papers

2026 “The Case of Apple’s Restrictions on Super Apps: Is the U.S. Department of Justice Right?” (Job Market Paper)

The novel “super app” technology, which emerged in the early 2010s, enables app developers to write and run a single version of an app on different operating systems. Apple’s alleged practice of restricting super apps in the United States is one of the subjects of a recent antitrust complaint filed by the U.S. Department of Justice (2024). I present a model of a two-sided market with cross-side network effects to investigate two questions: why Apple restricts super apps in the United States but not in Asia; and whether its restrictions may adversely affect market competition and welfare in the United States. I find that a primary reason for Apple’s behavior is the dominant position of its iOS platform on the consumer side of the U.S. smartphone market—iOS does not hold this position in Asia. I also identify three factors that determine the effects of Apple’s restrictions on the welfare of consumers and app developers.

2023 “Cheap Talk with Costly Information Acquisition the Receiver”

This paper explores the implications of the receiver’s costly information acquisition in a cheap-talk model. Contrary to the existing literature, I find that, regardless of the welfare weights and the change in the amount of information conveyed by the sender, not only a reduction in the cost of information acquisition but also an increase in the informativeness of the information source can induce welfare improvements in various situations. The results of this paper

also show that, in general, a cost reduction induces a welfare improvement in more cases than an increase in informativeness does.

Work in Progress

“Interdependent Bargains with Downstream Competition and Vertical Merger”
with David Sibley and Yihang Zhou

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

As an Assistant Instructor

Semester	Course
Fall 2025	ECO 329 Economic Statistics
Summer 2025	ECO n329 Economic Statistics-WB

As a Teaching Assistant

Semester	Course	Professor
Fall 2026	ECO 394K Microeconomics (Master level)	Gerald Oettinger
Spring 2026	ECO 352K Business Strategy	David Sibley
Fall 2024	ECO 353M Empirical Public Economics	David Sibley
Summer 2024	ECO f320L Macroeconomic Theory-WB	Trenton Herriford
Spring 2024	ECO 386D Microeconomics II (PhD level)	Svetlana Boyarchenko
Spring 2024	ECO 354K Introductory Game Theory	V. Bhaskar
Fall 2023	ECO 420K Microeconomic Theory	Gerald Oettinger
Summer 2023	ECO s395M 1-Real Analysis (Master level)	Kirk Blazek
Spring 2023	ECO 386D Microeconomics II (PhD level)	Svetlana Boyarchenko
Fall 2022	ECO 354K Introductory Game Theory	V. Bhaskar
Spring 2022	ECO 304K Introduction to Microeconomics	G. Dirk Mateer
Fall 2021	ECO 304K Intro to Microeconomics-WB	Charity-Joy Acchiardo & G. Dirk Mateer
Fall 2020	ECO 464 Competitive Strategy and Industrial Organization	Huseyin Yildirim

Others

Spring 2025	Supplemental Instruction Supervisor for Economics at Sanger Learning Center of the University of Texas at Austin
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SKILLS

Softwares & Tools	Matlab, Stata, Microsoft Office, L ^A T _E X
Language	English, professional working proficiency Mandarin, native or bilingual proficiency